



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lakewood Presbyterian School
School Website: <https://lakewoodpres.school/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Lakewood Presbyterian School (Dallas, TX 75214) presents a robust CLASSICAL profile rooted in a Christian worldview. The public materials consistently frame the school as a classical Christian institution that uses the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), emphasizes virtue-centered formation, and integrates biblical faith with intellectual pursuits. The school explicitly situates itself as "over 30 years of providing a classical Christian education" and describes its mission as forming resilient, thoughtful, capable Christians who will influence society for the glory of God. It foregrounds the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across grades, teaches Latin and other classical texts/periods, and blends memory work, Scripture, and poetry with rigorous argumentation and rhetoric in upper grades. The community emphasizes partnership with parents, Christ-centered identity, and a living-learning model where teachers and staff model virtue and serve as mentors. These elements align strongly with the Six Essential Elements rubric for a classical school and place this school solidly in the CLASSICAL category.

Key textual anchors include: the school's mission to form Christians who will "build, reform, and lead society to the glory of God," the explicit triad of grammar/logic/rhetoric across grade bands, the presence of Latin/Greek/World history taught through a classical Christian worldview, and the emphasis on memory work (poetry, Scripture) and debate/seminar-style discourse in upper grades. The school also emphasizes parent partnership and a Christ-centered community, which map to the classical model's sixth element (Parents & Community) as described in the normative rubric. Citations drawn from the school's site confirm these core attributes and practices.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Explicit Christ-centered and Christian worldview framing; core values emphasize Christ-exalting theology; mission foregrounds God-glorifying aims; references to biblical/scriptural content in academics (e.g., Scripture memorization) and biblical worldview in history; Chapel imagery and Christ-centered community language appear in site content.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Christ-centered, biblical worldview, theology, liturgical/congregational language, and "Christ is presented truly as He is" along with a clearly Christian mission. No explicit negative signals detected in the site materials.
 - Why this rating: The religious foundations are explicit, coherent, and integrated with curriculum and community life, aligning strongly with the classical rubric's emphasis on transcendental, real goods (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in a theistic framework.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The mission centers on forming virtuous Christians who will lead society to God's glory; emphasis on formation of character and moral imagination in the context of a Christian worldview; explicit commitment to a classical formation (Trivium).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include formation, virtue/character (implied in the language of resilience, thoughtfulness, courage), and telos aligned with truth, goodness,

beauty in a Christian framework. The site does not signal a non-formation or job-prep orientation; rather, it centers formation of character and faith-informed wisdom. 0 Negative keywords detected.

- Why this rating: The school's stated aim is formation of character and wisdom within a Christian teleology, not mere job preparation, which matches the classical category's highest tier.

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Curriculum sections outline the grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, Latin study, classical literature, history taught from a classical Christian worldview, and exposure to Greek, Roman, Renaissance, and Reformation history. The grammar/logic/rhetoric progression and the emphasis on memorization of Scripture/poetry reflect classical curricular priorities.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include grammar/logic/rhetoric, classical literature, Latin/Greek, history in a classical frame, and memorization of poetry and Scripture. The site emphasizes “classical literature” at the grammar level and a world-historical, classical approach to history. Negative signals are minimal; no strong modernist/skills-first phrasing detected. Estimated positive keyword presence is high; negative keyword indicators are minimal.
- Why this rating: The curriculum aligns with the Trivium framework and a classical-liberal, history-rich program, with explicit classical texts and languages, even as Scripture/memorization supplements. This supports a CLASSICAL classification.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The lower grades emphasize memory work, singing, and liturgical/reverent form; upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training; there is explicit progression to speech and rhetoric with opportunities for students to present and argue.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include singing/memorization in lower grades, contemplation/wonder (implied by the integrated, period-based pedagogy), Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric-centered oral work in the upper grades. The presence of both contemplative/restful elements and active dialectic suggests a balanced pedagogy. No negative signals detected in the materials.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy explicitly weaves memory work, chant, and recitation in the early grades with Socratic and rhetorical training in the upper grades, matching the classical model's pedagogical spectrum.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Faculty are presented as mentors and model teachers; the staff page highlights the Headmaster, elementary principal, and classroom teachers; the school emphasizes a “living curriculum” and close faculty-student relationships; the administration and staff are described as central in shaping the school culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of what a teacher should be, and collegial culture (as inferred from the site's emphasis on teacher leadership and partnership with families). While not all of the lexicon terms may appear verbatim, the public materials convey the intended faculty role. Negative signals are not evident.
- Why this rating: The site emphasizes teachers as central to the educational mission, highlights leadership roles, and frames faculty as mentors and living exemplars—core elements of a classical faculty profile.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school stresses partnership with parents as co-teachers, parental formation, open access to visits, and a Christ-centered community. The admissions content and “Our Community” language emphasize collaboration with families and a welcoming environment for parental involvement.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “partnership with families,” “co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “open campus/visits,” and “Christ-centered community.” Negative keywords are not evident in the site materials.
- Why this rating: The school explicitly positions parents as partners in education and offers avenues for parental formation and ongoing involvement, aligning well with the classical category's expectations for parent/community partnership.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The school's public-facing materials consistently reflect classical education tenets (Trivium, Great Books-oriented tradition elements, Latin/Greek/history within a classical Christian framework) and align with the Six Essential Elements' positive indicators across religious foundations, formation goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty roles, and parent/community partnerships. The Christian framing and the structured classical progression are particularly salient and well-supported by the site content. The balance of contemplative/memory-based approaches in the lower grades and dialectic/rhetoric in the upper grades further reinforces a robust classical pedagogy.

What would move the needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- If the school sought to reach the upper bound of classical alignment, it could explicitly foreground:
 - Great Books and Great Conversation language in curriculum or communications (e.g., listing specific authors or works representative of the Great Books canon) to strengthen alignment with the "Great Books/Great Conversation" criterion.
 - More explicit liturgical/prayer practices beyond Chapel imagery and Christ-centered language (e.g., daily or weekly chapel liturgies, liturgical calendar integration) to reinforce liturgical/community practices in the pedagogical setting.
 - Expanded articulation of the "living books" and "mimetic learning" aspects in the faculty and curriculum sections to align with the full lexicon of classical education.

These would be needle-moving steps toward full alignment with the full classical lexicon, but the current materials already establish a strong classical/Christian framework. No major shifts appear necessary for CLASSICAL status, though the above would push toward a more explicit, textbook-level alignment with every element in the Six Essentials lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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